Awami League MP—being set afire was being passed off as an attack on the residence of Hindu cricketer Liton Das. A BBC Verify report shows how a fire in an Awami League office in Chattogram was passed off as an attack on a temple. There have also been many instances of students and people from the Muslim community guarding Hindu temples in the aftermath of August 5.

While fake news often is a distorted amplification of actual events, atrocities against Hindus by fundamentalists, Jamaat-e-Islami cadres and miscreants of all types have been alleged for decades. Yunus, in his first address to the nation, said that attacks on minorities were part of "a conspiracy" and it was the new government's duty to protect all. He visited the famous Dhakeswari temple in Old Dhaka on August 13 to show solidarity with Hindus. He also met Hindu leaders on August 26 on the occasion of Janmashtami. "Our responsibility is to establish rights and ensure justice for every citizen," Yunus said during the meeting.

The Council, in an August 13 letter to Yunus, urged that compensation be paid and rehabilitation guaranteed to victims of communal violence. In addition, they demanded a minority protection law, a national commission and dedicated ministry for minorities, and implementation of the Elimination of Discrimination Act. These are not the only demands. There is also the proper implementation of the Chittagong Hill Tracts Accord and the Chittagong Hill Tracts Regional Council Act—which recognise the rights of the (mostly Buddhist) indigenous hill people—as well as national holidays during Durga Puja, Prabarana Purnima (observed by Buddhists) and on Easter Sunday. ■



SEEKING JUSTICE BJP leader Gouri Shanker Shrivas leads a demonstration against the recruitment scam at the PSC headquarters in Raipur, Jul. 2022

CHHATTISGARH

RECRUITMENT ROT

By Rahul Noronha

With the Puja Khedkar controversy, where the probationary IAS wrongfully availed OBC quota benefits, still echoing in the public's mind, another recruitment scandal threatens to shake the foundations of India's elite services. The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) recently conducted raids at the premises of former Chhattisgarh Public Services Commission (CGPSC) office-bearers and others, as the alleged corruption that has gripped the state since May last year continues to unravel.

The CBI executed coordinated searches at 16 locations across the state, marking its second operation within a month. During the raids, substantial electronic evidence was seized and has been sent to labs for testing, say the agency sources.

What is the scandal about? In May 2023, the CGPSC announced the results of the civil services exam held in 2021-22. A closer look revealed that some of the successful candidates included relatives of high-ranking CGPSC officials and politicians, raising allegations of nepotism.

While the then Congress government turned a blind eye to the allegations of wrongdoing, the BJP promised it would order a CBI inquiry if voted to power. In February, the state's economic offences wing, under the new government, took up the case and later asked the government to hand it over to the CBI. In mid-July, the agency registered a case against the then CGPSC chairman and former IAS officer Taman Singh Sonwane, secretary J.K.